

Proper Nutrition Supports:

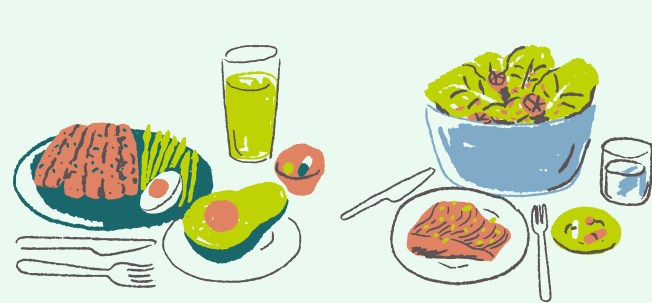
(ACOG, 2026)

- Growth of your baby
- Placental growth
- Healthy pregnancy+weight gain
- Breast milk production
- Post partum healing + energy

While your body has specific needs to best support your growing baby and changing body a balanced diet will cover most of your nutrition needs. (FDA, 2024)

An example dinner would look like:

- Baked salmon over brown rice and broccoli
- Grilled chicken with sweet potato and spinach



Other foods to try include (FDA, 2024):

- Kale and lettuce
- Lean meat, poultry, eggs
- Flounder and shrimp
- Oats and whole-wheat bread
- Beans and lentils

Fast Facts

(Hockenberry et al., 2023)

- Stay hydrated! Aim for 8-10 cups of water daily from pregnancy to postpartum to support growing your baby and recovery
- Be sure to also drink a glass of water each time you nurse
- Prenatal vitamins can supplement a healthy diet, but do not replace balanced nutrition. Follow your provider’s guidance on supplement.
- Weight guidance: aim for 25-35lb gain for normal pre-pregnancy BMI
- Breastfed babies need vitamin D supplementation (400 IU). Talk to your provider about options!

Signs your baby is eating well (AAP, 2025)



- Increase in wet diapers
- Steady weight gain
- Audible swallowing
- Content after feeds

References

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Healthy Nutrition for Mom and Baby

HOW TO SUPPORT YOUR BODY + BABY THROUGH

- PREGNANCY
- POST PARTUM
- BREAST FEEDING



Mallory Fries

This pamphlet was created using Canva. Claude (Anthropic) was used for brainstorming organization of content. All content, wording and design is the author’s original work.

Key Tips for Pregnancy

Nutrition

Focus on Increasing (ACOG 2026; Hockenberry et al., 2023)

- **Folic acid** (600mcg)→ help baby's brain and spine grow
- **Iron** (30 mg) → prevent anemia, deliver O2 to baby
- **calcium** (1000 mg)→ fetal skeletal + tooth growth
- **Vitamin B12** (2.6 mcg)→ forms red blood cells + supports neurual function
- **Vitamin C** (80mg)→ helps tissue formation
- **Protein** (71 g)→ growth of maternal+ fetal tissue
- **Fiber** (28g)→ help bowel movements
- **Healthy Fats**→ supports brain development
- **Whole grains**→ provide fiber, vitamins, and minerals
- **Vegetables** (2.5-3 cups)→ contains vitamins/minerals



Avoid (FDA, 2024; Hockenberry et al., 2023)

- Alcohol (there is no safe amount in pregnancy!)
- Limit caffine < 200mg/day
- Raw/undercooked meat, fish or eggs
- High-mercury fish: Swordfish and Mackerel
- Unwashed fruit or vegetables
- Unpasteurized dairy and soft cheeses (to prevent listeria)

Postpartum & Breastfeeding

Nutrition

(Hockenberry et al., 2023)

Your body needs extra nutrition after birth. You can use proper nutrition to support both physical and mental recovery.

Foods that Support Healing

- **Protein**→ include in every meal (eggs, chicken, greek yogurt)
- **Iron rich foods** → rebuild after blood loss (spinich,
- **Vitamin C**→ aid tissue repair (oranges, bell peppers, berries)
- **High fiber foods+ water**→ prevent constipation (black beans, oats, broccoli)
- **Omega-3s**→ can help improve mood postpartum (salmon, walnuts, chia seeds)

Breast Feeding uses energy. So you need more calories!

Add about 450 extra calories a day and continue your prenatal vitamin

Try These Snacks

- Yogurt parfait
- Peanut butter on toast
- Nuts and cheese



Feeding Your Newborn

Benefits of Breastfeeding (AAP, 2025)



- Ideal nutrition + adapts to your baby's needs
- Help protect from infection
- Supports bonding + recovery

Newborns feed 8-12 times in 24 hours (CDC, 2024)

Watch for hunger cues to feed (AAP, 2025)

- Hand-to-mouth
- Lip-smacking
- Fussing

Never Give your Baby (less than 12 months old)

- Water
- Juice
- Honey
- Cow or other animal's milk (Hockenberry et al., 2023)

Tips for Formula Feeding (CDC, 2024)

- Most infants take 1-2 oz every 2-3 hours
- Always wash hands with soap and water for 20 seconds before making the formula
- Use water from a safe source
- Follow instructions on label for mixing
- Never use microwave for heating